4.4 Using a configuration server with Spring Cloud Config Client

The Config Service application built in the previous section is a server that exposes configuration through a REST API. In general, applications would interact with this API, but you can use Spring Cloud Config Client for Spring applications.

This section will teach you how to use Spring Cloud Config Client and integrate Catalog Service with the config server. You'll see how to make the interaction more robust and how to refresh the client's configuration when new changes are pushed to the config repo.

4.4.1 Setting up a configuration client

The first thing you'll need to do to integrate a Spring Boot application with a config server is add a new dependency to Spring Cloud Config Client. Update the build.gradle file for the Catalog Service project (catalog-service) as follows. Remember to refresh or reimport the Gradle dependencies after the new addition.

Listing 4.14 Adding dependency for Spring Cloud Config Client

```
ext {
  set('springCloudVersion', "2021.0.3")
}

dependencies {
  ...
  implementation 'org.springframework.cloud:spring-cloud-starter-config'
}

dependencyManagement {
  imports {
    mavenBom "org.springframework.cloud:
    ➥ spring-cloud-dependencies:${springCloudVersion}"
```